

general trends. Overall, was the kith loyalist? Did they side with the rebels? Did they, like the sidhe, reappear on Earth after a long absence and have to reintegrate, or were they right there alongside the commoner kiths during the Interregnum?

Think about the role the kith plays in changeling society, and what kind of reputation the members have. When changelings need something fixed, they seek out a nocker. If they needed to learn ancient, forbidden lore, they could do worse than a sluagh or eshu. What is this kith known for? In a game of **Changeling**, without allowing for concept or specifics, what would this kith *do*?

Consider this question on multiple levels: courts, freeholds, and motleys. Within the two courts, how does this kith approach the problem of obtaining Glamour, inspiring Dreamers, and the other sticking points between Seelie and Unseelie? Does the kith have a presence in the Shadow Court? For that matter, does it have a Thallain equivalent? (You may feel free to leave this question to the Storyteller and be surprised and horrified in play.)

In a freehold, what is the kith's function? Does the kith, on the whole, take part in the neo-feudalism of Kithain society, or, like the selkies, do they largely opt out? If the latter, why and how? More to the point, if they don't choose to take part in changeling society, what role is there for them to play in a chronicle?

Finally, within a motley, what social role do members of the kith fulfill? Sidhe can be leaders, but they can also be romantic figures. Trolls are strong, steady, and loyal. Pooka lie, yes, but they also make superb confidantes (as do boggans, for different reasons). Don't feel that your kith needs to find a completely new and untouched niche; that would be difficult anyway. Instead, think about how members of the kith interact with the others and try and find some interesting combinations.

Stereotypes

Looking at the kith writeups in the last chapter, you'll notice that each one has a set of stereotypes — what the given kith thinks of the others. These are obviously meant to portray generalities and broad strokes, with a bit of flavor. The piskey's stereotype of redcaps begins with "Avoid at all costs!" — but that doesn't mean that in *your* chronicle, the piskey and the redcap can't be friends. It just gives players a jumping-off point for their interactions.

You can make up these stereotypes, too. You don't need to write them down, necessarily, just think about how a member of your new kith would react when asked "what do you think about trolls?" At the same time, describe the kith — again, broad strokes — to a player in your troupe and ask what her character would think about this kith. The stereotypes can't hope to cover all the peculiarities, but they should contain at least a hint of truth and logic.

Step Three: Birthrights

All kiths have two Birthrights, chosen from three categories. When choosing and creating Birthrights, consider the following points:

Engaging the Mythology: Choose something about the existing mythology of the kith (if any) that interests and inspires you. You don't have to fit an entire myth into the kith — the existing **Changeling** kiths certainly don't! Consider the pooka, for instance; their Birthright allows them to change into a particular animal, but does not restrict them to black rabbits, goats, or horses, which would have been in keeping with many of the Irish folktales surrounding them. Likewise, the trolls of **Changeling: The Dreaming** aren't hideous or evil, but are strong and hardworking (note that the "hideous/evil" side of the kith does emerge in their Thallain counterparts, which is a perfectly acceptable tactic to take here).

Dealing with Mortals: Kithain come from the dreams of mortals. Boggans not only excel at performing household tasks, they enjoy doing it — it is, in a very real sense, what they were made to do. Think about the kinds of dreams that spawned the kith, and then consider how that might translate to a Birthright.

Tell a Good Story: A game of **Changeling** isn't one character walking into the scene and "winning." It's a tale of a group of characters experiencing and triumphing over adversity (or succumbing to it; tragedy can be just as satisfying as victory for the right troupe). A new kith's Birthrights should lend themselves to making interesting and exciting things happen in the story, not resolving the story quickly. This is the real meaning of game balance: not that all Birthrights are inherently equal (they're far too subjective and diverse for that), but that all Birthrights can give the character a way to push the story in new and creative ways.

The four categories of Birthrights are as follows:

Acuity

Acuity Birthrights enable changelings to perform mundane tasks with amazing precision. In game terms, they modify Abilities (or occasionally Attributes), either by ensuring that the changeling cannot botch a particular Trait roll (a botched roll counts as a normal failure) or that rolls on the given Trait enjoy a reduced difficulty.

The player has some wiggle room as to exactly how these systems are applied. For example, the kith might be supernaturally gifted at healing — all Medicine rolls enjoy a -1 difficulty. Or, the kith might be exceptionally gifted at one particular application of an Ability. For instance, a brutal kith that specializes in breaking bones might apply a -2 difficulty to any attacks meant to do so.

A single Birthright can combine multiple applications of Acuity, provided they work together thematically and that the Storyteller doesn't feel that the player is getting out of control. Selkies, for instance, enjoy a -2 difficulty to all Dexterity rolls, and cannot botch Athletics rolls, as long as the character is in the water. In general, the more widely applicable the Acuity is, the less inclined the Storyteller should be to let a player